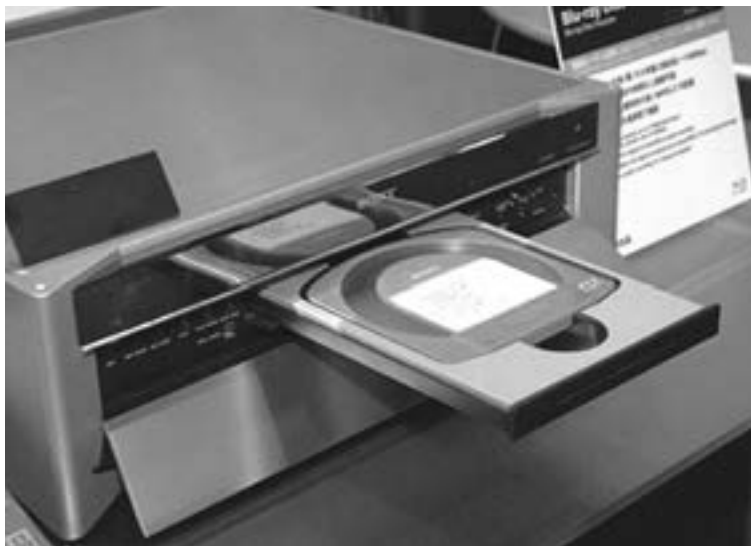




storing large amounts of data. A single-layer Blu-ray Disc can hold 25 GB of data and can be used to record over 2 hours of HDTV or more than 13 hours of standard-definition TV.

There are also versions of dual-layer discs that can hold up to 50 GB of data. This is five times the amount of space available on current DVDs. So is everything a bed of in the future? You could not be more wrong!

Blu-ray's chief and perhaps only competitor is HD-DVD whose major proponents are Microsoft and Toshiba. According to Toshiba, the current DVD and HD DVD share the same basic disc structure: back-to-back bonding of two 120mm diameter substrates, each 0.6mm thick. As a result, HD DVD combines advanced capabilities with essential backward compatibility. The HD DVD standard clearly promotes early and cost efficient disc and hardware production, assures quality, availability, and marketability.

Here is a small table that should give you a general idea of how these two formats fare against the normal DVD.